



what is likely to occur during your pregnancy, from procedures and ultrasounds to birth plans and labor techniques. You will learn about nutrition and exercise, and how to keep healthy, as well as the biological changes taking place in your body and your baby's. There are also sections on clothes to buy to accommodate your increasingly large belly, and also what to buy to prepare for your new arrival. You'll find guidance on all concerns from common complaints during the first trimester to taking care of your newborn. When the time comes to seek advice from your own obstetrician, we have asked you to do so.

Your journey to birth and beyond

The story of the beginnings of your baby's life is told in a visually beautiful, easy-to-read, and factually

accurate account. Throughout, in-depth medical information and authoritative advice will enable you to feel confident about what to expect before, during, and after the birth, while information on lifestyle, working, and well-being will help you have a balanced and joyful pregnancy, and look forward to meeting the newest member of your family.

To all those contemplating pregnancy, or who are already pregnant, I hope you will find that this fascinating book helps you understand and enjoy the very beginning of your baby's life.

Dr. Chandrima Biswas

Consultant **Dr. Su Laurent** MRCP, FRCPCH

Dr. Su Laurent has been a consulting pediatrician at Barnet Hospital, London since 1993. Her special interests include asthma, and the interaction between the mind and body and how this affects physical health. She has written several books on parenting and child health. She is the medical advisor to the charity Child Bereavement UK and was the expert pediatrician for *Mother and Baby* magazine for many years.

Consultant **Professor Lesley Page CBE** PhD MSc BA RM RN Honorary DSc HFRCM

Professor Lesley Page is president of the Royal College of Midwives. She was the first professor of midwifery in the UK at Thames Valley University and Queen Charlotte's Hospital. She is a renowned international academic, advocate, and activist for midwives, mothers, and babies. She has contributed to the development of woman centered maternity care. She has practiced midwifery in the community, hospital, and home-birth settings for more than 32 years.

US Consultant Editor **Paula Amato** M.D.

Dr. Paula Amato is a reproductive endocrinologist and is an associate professor at the Oregon Health and Science University (OHSU) in Oregon. She received her degree from the University of Toronto, where she also completed her residency in obstetrics and gynecology. She was subsequently a fellow in reproductive endocrinology and infertility at the University of California. She is board certified in obstetrics, gynecology, reproductive endocrinology, and infertility.